

DRUM One of the cylindrical stone blocks that compose most columns. The drum is also the circular or polygonal structure on which a dome sits. *See also* dome.

E

EAVES The edges of a roof that overhang the walls of a building.

ECHAL The enclosure containing the ark in a synagogue, which in turn holds the synagogue's Torah scrolls. It is also written as hekhal, hechal, or heichal. *See also* synagogue.

ECLECTICISM An architectural style that incorporates a mixture of historic styles to create something new and original, as opposed to simply reviving an older style. It flourished in the 19th and 20th centuries.

EGYPTIAN REVIVAL An architectural style that incorporates the forms, motifs, and imagery of ancient Egypt. It became popular following Napoleon's conquest of Egypt in 1798 and briefly again after the discovery of the tomb of Tutankhamun in 1922.

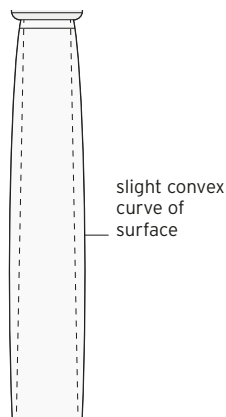
ELEVATION A flat representation of one side of a building, usually the facade. The term is most commonly used in reference to architectural drawings.

ENFILADE A series of openings between rooms and spaces that align along an axis to provide an extended view.

ENGAGED COLUMN A column that is partially embedded in a wall. The columns are load-bearing and also act as buttresses for the wall; they are distinct from pilasters, which are purely decorative. *See also* pilaster.

ENTABLATURE *See* panel, below.

ENTASIS ▼ The addition of a slight convex curve to a structure for aesthetic purposes. For example, the columns of the Parthenon in Athens curve slightly to counteract the fact that columns with straight sides appear to the eye to be more slender in the middle and have a waist.



ENVIRONMENTAL DESIGN

The practice of considering environmental factors when carrying out urban planning or building design.

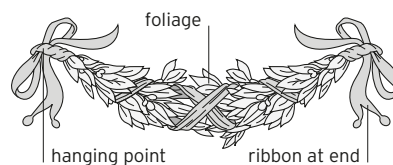
ESPLANADE A pedestrian walkway, often on a seafront. In North America, an esplanade is also a strip of raised land dividing a road.

F

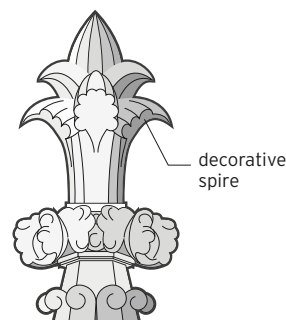
FABRIC The load-bearing structure of a building.

FACADE The front or main face of a building.

FAN VAULT A form of highly decorative ceiling vault with ribs radiating out from a central column, like a fan. It is associated with the Gothic style and is mostly found in the ecclesiastical architecture of England. *See also* Gothic, vault.



FESTOON ▲ A form of stone-carved ornamentation depicting a wreath or garland hanging from two points.



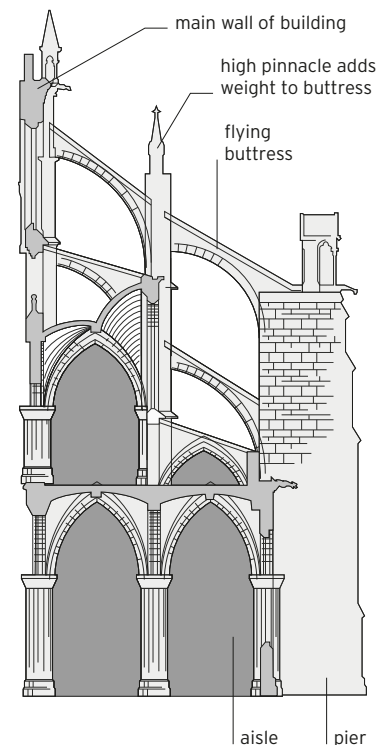
FINIAL ▲ The uppermost part of a pinnacle, spire, minaret, or gable end. This usually has some decorative element, such as a spike or knob.

FLAMBOYANT A style of Gothic architecture popularized in 15th-century France and Spain with an emphasis on decoration. Its main characteristic is the use of a flamelike S-shaped curve in stone tracery. *See also* Gothic, tracery.

FLÈCHE A small spire set on the ridge of a church or cathedral roof.

FLEURON A stone-carved, flower-shaped ornament.

FLUTING The shallow grooves running vertically on a column or pilaster and occasionally on other surfaces. Fluted columns are particularly associated with the architecture of ancient Greece; columns of the Doric order have 20 flutes, while Ionic and Corinthian columns traditionally have 24. *See also* order.



FLYING BUTTRESS ▲ A type of buttress with a free-standing pier from which extends an arched structure that connects with and

ENTABLATURE

The entablature is the name for the combined horizontal elements that sit on top of a column in a Classical structure. It generally comprises a decorative architrave and, above that, a plain frieze, although sometimes the frieze may have sculpted reliefs. The whole structure is topped by a decorative cornice. Frequently in Classical architecture, the entablature will be topped by a pediment.

